INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Customer Relations

APPAREL AND ACCESSORIES MARKETING SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Handle customer/client complaints.
2. Handle difficult customers.
3. Interpret business policies to customers/clients.
4. Develop rapport with customers.
5. Communicate core values of product/service.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the assistant store manager at HARLOW, a mid-priced apparel chain. A customer (judge) is upset about the store credit offered through HARLOW's new clothing trade-in program.

Six months ago, HARLOW launched HARLOW AGAIN, a program that lets customers bring gently used HARLOW clothing to any store for store credit. Each item is graded by condition and earns $3 to $15 in credit. Items with stains, holes or pilling are not accepted, and neither are clothes from other brands. Accepted items are cleaned and resold in the HARLOW AGAIN section of the store. HARLOW promotes the program as part of its commitment to keeping clothing out of landfills.

The customer (judge) saw a social media video that said HARLOW pays "up to $15 per item" and brought in 12 items, expecting about $100 in credit. Four items were from other brands and three had stains or pilling, so they were not accepted. The other five items earned $31 in store credit. The customer (judge) is angry, says the program is "a scam" and is threatening to post a video about the experience.

You will speak with the customer (judge) in a role-play to take place at the store's customer service counter. The customer (judge) will begin the role-play by explaining the problem. After you have handled the situation and have answered the customer's (judge's) questions, the customer (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your help.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. You are going to turn around and sell my clothes for $20 apiece. Isn't HARLOW just making money off of me?
2. If I still post a video about today, what do you hope I tell my followers about HARLOW AGAIN?

	Rate the participant's ability to:	Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Handle customer/client complaints.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Handle difficult customers.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Interpret business policies to customers/clients.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Develop rapport with customers.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Communicate core values of product/service.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
4.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
5.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
6.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
7.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
8.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
9.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
10.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	